Model Structure (26.2c_FAA_3Flt):

This is a Fleets−as−Areas model (do_spatial == 1).
There are 2 sexes, 4 fishing fleets, 5 survey fleets, and 1 regions being modeled.
The model has 66 years, starting in 1960 and ending in 2025.
There are 30 ages, where recruitment occurs at age−2 and the plus group occurs at age−31.
There are 30 length bins, which start at 41cm and end at 99cm.

Growth Estimation:

This model estimates new growth curves for the post−1996 time block (upd_growth == 1, use_new_bio == 2) and uses the 2021 SAFE growth estimates for the pre−1996 time block (use_hist_grwth_blk == 1, do_rec_growth == 0). A new weight curve is estimated with a single block (do_rec_WAA == 0).
For fishery composition data aggregation catch−weighting, the newly estimated sex−disaggregated Weight parameters are used to convert to catch in numbers (sex_disagg_comp_wt == 1).

Aleutian Islands (AI) Data Use:

This model uses data from the Aleutian Islands (AI) −− no data is being removed (drop_AI == 0).

Longline Survey Index Construction:

There was a longline survey in 2025, so there is a terminal year LLS RPN value (LLS_active == 1).

The extrapolated values for the western AI longline survey stations were NOT included in the LLS RPN index (drop_WAI_LLS == 1).

The longline survey did NOT use off−year extrapolations for the BS (even years) or AI (odd years).
Only the non−extrapolated area RPNs were included in the index (drop_LLS_extrap == 1 & do_LLS_carry == 0).
The FAA model is not using a carryover version of the LLS RPN index (do_spatial == 1 & do_carry_FAA == 0).

The SPoRC model is being passed the index SEs, no conversions needed (do_cont_SE == 1).

Composition Data Structure and ISS:

Composition proportions by age/length are aggregated across regions after weighting by catch in numbers or RPNs.

Age and length compositions are fit 'joint' by sex, but lengths are dropped for years when ages exist (JPN LLS lengths are kept for all years) (do_spatial > 0 & sex_age_comps == 5).
The Input Sample Size (ISS) for composition data is scaled to a maximum value across years/sexes/fleets to address interannual variability (do_spatial == 1 & do_scale_ISS == 1).

Length Composition Data Use:

The longline survey length composition data is weighted/calculated using the raw length data and weighted by area RPNs consistent with the age composition data (LLS_length_comp_source == 1).
No longline survey length data are fit in the model (this does not apply to JPN LLS lengths) −− only age data are used (fit_LLS_len == 0).
No fixed gear fishery length data are fit in the model (this does not apply to trawl fishery lengths) −− only age data are used (fit_LLF_len == 0).

General Data Fitting Notes:

Fishery whale depredation estimates were fixed/static at the previous year's values (whale_dep_static == 1).
The GOA trawl survey data was NOT fit in this model (use_trwl_srvy == 0).
The fishery CPUE index was NOT fit in this model (use_CPUE == 0).
Non−fishery catch (e.g., scientific removals) WAS included in the model as fixed gear catch, where only LLS removals were available for terminal year (add_non_fish_catch == 1 & non_fsh_catch_updated == 0).